

THE CLAIM

Your number one ranking
is now the **third click**
nobody makes.

The summary answers the question before the reader reaches your page. The ranking still exists. The visit often does not.

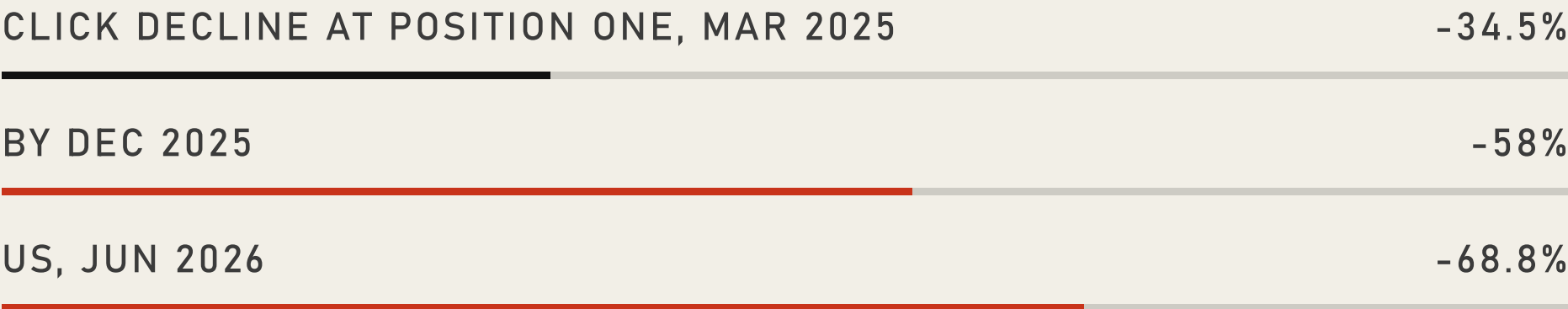
QUERIES WITH AN AI OVERVIEW	42%
AIO PLACED ABOVE THE FIRST RESULT	85%
AIO KEYWORDS THAT ARE INFORMATIONAL	99.2%

Sources: CMU and ISB field experiment, SSRN, April 2026; Ahrefs, 300,000 keyword study, October 2024.

02 / WHAT IT COSTS

Position one lost 68.8% of its clicks in the US.

Position one used to be the whole game. It is now the most exposed position on the page.



Ahrefs tracked the same 300,000 keywords from March 2025 to June 2026. Japan fell 62.7% over the same period.

03 / THE PROOF

42%

of Google queries now show an AI Overview, and 85% of those sit above the first organic result.

QUERIES WITH AN AI OVERVIEW	42%
AIO ABOVE THE FIRST RESULT	85%
ORGANIC CLICKS LOST IN THE FIELD EXPERIMENT	38%
ZERO-CLICK SHARE BEFORE AIO	54%
ZERO-CLICK SHARE AFTER AIO	72%

Randomised field experiment, Carnegie Mellon University and Indian School of Business, SSRN, April 2026.

04 / HOW THE CLICK DIES

The answer arrives before the **decision** to click.

STEP 01

The query is answered inside the results page

STEP 02

The reader accepts the summary and stops

STEP 03

Your page is never opened

CLICK RATE WITH AN AI OVERVIEW	8%
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CLICK RATE WITHOUT AN AI OVERVIEW	15%
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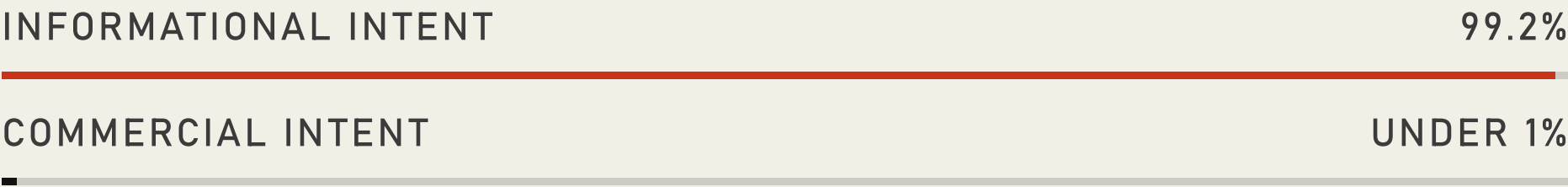
Pew Research Center on click behaviour with and without AI Overviews.

05 / THE TWIST

Almost every keyword being summarised is **informational**.

99.2%

Share of AI Overview keywords that are informational rather than transactional.



DATASET 300,000 keywords

STUDY Ahrefs, October 2024

Ahrefs, 300,000 keyword study, October 2024. Transactional pages keep most of their clicks.

Defend the pages that still **convert**.

01 Separate informational pages from converting pages

AI Overviews concentrate on informational queries, so transactional pages keep their clicks. That is where the traffic plan belongs.

02 Write the answer, then earn the click

If the summary cites you, the reader still needs a reason to open. Put the tool, the template or the depth behind the click.

03 Measure zero-click demand, not only sessions

Track impressions and citations on the queries that no longer produce sessions, or the decline reads as failure.

Sources: Ahrefs, October 2024; CMU and ISB, April 2026; Pew Research Center.

THE TAKEAWAY

Check one keyword today. Is your answer inside the summary?

If it is, you are already feeding
the answer. The next job is
making the page worth opening.

STEP ONE	search your main query and look for the AIO
STEP TWO	count how many sources it cites
FOLLOW	if you are fixing this too

Sources: Ahrefs; CMU and ISB; Pew Research Center.